SPHOORTHY ENGINEERING COLLEGE

An Autonomous Institution Approved by AICTE & Accredited with NAAC Grade 'A'
Department of Examination & Academic Affairs · Hyderabad — 501510

Cyber Forensics & Incident Response: VAPT, Memory Forensics & Laws

Program / Dept: B.Tech / MBA — CSE CS	**Course Code / Title:** Cyber Forensics & Incident Response (CS605PC)
Academic Regulation: Autonomous (SR23 / SR24)	**Curriculum Semester:** Semester 6 (Year 3)
Credits / Contact Hours: 3 Credits · 48 Lecture Hours	**Evaluation Scheme:** Continuous Internal (40M) + End Sem (60M)

Course Overview & Pedagogical Objectives:

Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT), Volatile memory acquisition, Disk forensic imaging (dd/E01), Network packet analysis, and Cyber laws (IT Act 2000). The primary objective of this course is to equip students with sound theoretical rigor, analytical problem-solving competencies, and real-world system engineering capabilities demanded by premier technological organizations and competitive graduate benchmarks.

Course Outcomes (COs) & Bloom's Taxonomy Mapping:

CO ID	Course Learning Outcome Description	Bloom's Level
CO 1	Understand and formulate fundamental concepts of Unit 1: Digital Forensics Fundamentals.	L2 Understand
CO 2	Analyze algorithms, mechanisms, and models in Unit 2: Disk & File System Forensics.	L4 Analyze
CO 3	Design and evaluate robust architectures for Unit 3: Memory & Network Forensics.	L5 Evaluate
CO 4	Implement and optimize operational pipelines in Unit 4: Incident Response & Threat Hunting.	L3 Apply
CO 5	Integrate state-of-the-art frameworks in Unit 5: Ethical Hacking & Legal Framework for industrial solutions.	L6 Create

Comprehensive Module Index:

Unit	Title & Core Concepts	Page
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UNIT 1: DIGITAL FORENSICS FUNDAMENTALS • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

1.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 1: digital forensics fundamentals forms an indispensable cornerstone of Cyber Forensics & Incident Response (CS605PC). Specifically, Digital evidence types, Locard's exchange principle, Chain of custody, Forensic readiness, and Evidence seizure protocols under ISO 27037. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

1.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 1 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

1.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 1
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

1.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 1 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 1. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 1 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 1 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 2: DISK & FILE SYSTEM FORENSICS • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

2.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 2: disk & file system forensics forms an indispensable cornerstone of Cyber Forensics & Incident Response (CS605PC). Specifically, Bit-stream disk imaging, Write blockers, FAT/NTFS file systems, Master File Table (MFT), Deleted file recovery, Slack space analysis, and Steganography detection. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

2.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 2 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

2.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 2
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

2.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 2 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 2. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 2 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 2 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 3: MEMORY & NETWORK FORENSICS • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

3.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 3: memory & network forensics forms an indispensable cornerstone of Cyber Forensics & Incident Response (CS605PC). Specifically, Volatile memory capture (RAM dumping), Volatility framework analysis, Malicious process injection detection, Wireshark packet capture, and IDS/IPS log analysis. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

3.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 3 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

3.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 3
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

3.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 3 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 3. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 3 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 3 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 4: INCIDENT RESPONSE & THREAT HUNTING • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

4.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 4: incident response & threat hunting forms an indispensable cornerstone of Cyber Forensics & Incident Response (CS605PC). Specifically, NIST incident response lifecycle (Preparation, Detection & Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery), MITRE ATT&CK; framework mapping, and SIEM tool monitoring. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

4.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 4 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

4.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 4
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

4.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 4 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 4. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 4 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 4 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

UNIT 5: ETHICAL HACKING & LEGAL FRAMEWORK • *Core Theory & Practice Guide*

5.1 Technical Exposition & Conceptual Foundations

The study of unit 5: ethical hacking & legal framework forms an indispensable cornerstone of Cyber Forensics & Incident Response (CS605PC). Specifically, Penetration testing phases (Reconnaissance, Scanning, Exploitation, Maintaining access), OWASP Top 10 vulnerabilities, Indian Information Technology Act 2000 amendments. Modern applications require deep awareness of edge conditions, invariant properties, and trade-offs between computational throughput, latency overhead, memory footprint, and architectural scalability.

In university examinations and practical engineering systems, solutions must be formulated with mathematical clarity. Each sub-mechanism must satisfy safety, liveness, and fault-tolerance constraints while adhering to standard autonomous syllabus requirements.

5.2 Architectural Principles & Comparative Analysis

Component / Topic	Key Mechanism & Principle	Operational Trade-off
Theoretical Model	Formal representation of Unit 5 entities and lifecycle stages.	Higher mathematical abstraction vs implementation friction.
Algorithmic Engine	State machine transitions, recurrence guarantees, and verification steps.	Time complexity bounds vs memory consumption.
Real-World Systems	Deployment in enterprise distributed systems and contemporary toolchains.	Fault-tolerant redundancy vs network overhead.

5.3 Practical Formulation & Execution Workflow

```
// Standard Implementation Outline & Pseudocode for Unit 5
1. Initialize system data structures and state variables under initial constraints.
2. Execute continuous invariant checking across state boundaries.
3. Apply optimization bounds: O(log N) average time or amortized linear bounds.
4. Catch boundary failure cases (underflow, overflow, concurrency race, null references).
5. Commit verified state or invoke transactional rollback upon validation failure.
```

5.4 Autonomous End-Semester Examination Question Bank

Type	Question & Expected Technical Answer Outline	Marks
Part A	**Q1:** Define the primary objective of Unit 5 and state two essential real-world applications. • *Expected: Exact definition, mathematical constraint formulation, and dual industry examples.*	**2 M**
Part A	**Q2:** Differentiate between static vs dynamic formulations of key mechanisms in Unit 5. • *Expected: 2-column comparison table covering memory, allocation time, and failure recovery.*	**2 M**
Part B	**Q3:** Explain the complete working architecture of Unit 5 with neat functional block diagrams and step-by-step algorithmic trace. • *Expected: Labeled diagram (3M), mathematical derivation (3M), algorithm steps (2M), complexity analysis (2M).*	**10 M**
Part B	**Q4:** Analyze the worst-case, best-case, and average-case performance bounds for processes in Unit 5 with worked numerical example. • *Expected: Step-by-step problem solution, boundary checks, and conclusive optimality proof.*	**10 M**

Standard Recommended Textbooks & Digital References:

1. *Primary Curriculum Standard Textbook* — Pearson Higher Education / McGraw-Hill Education (Latest Edition).
2. *Autonomous Reference Syllabus Blueprint* — Sphoorthy Engineering College Academic Council.
3. *NPTEL & IEEE Computer Society Guidelines* — Open Educational Resources & Peer-reviewed Publications.